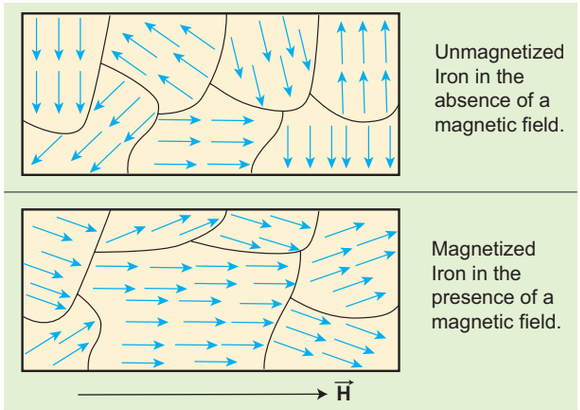


Figure 3.21 Processes of domain magnetization

When placed in a non-uniform magnetic field, the ferromagnetic materials will have a strong tendency to move from weaker to stronger part of the field. Materials which exhibit strong magnetism in the direction of applied field are called ferromagnetic materials. Examples: Iron, Nickel and Cobalt.

The properties of ferromagnetic materials are:

DO YOU KNOW?

Magnetism plays interesting role in various aspects of life. It has connection with archeological place Keezhadi too. To find whether any archeological structure exists under the surface of a given place, well established technique called 'magnetometer surveying' is used.

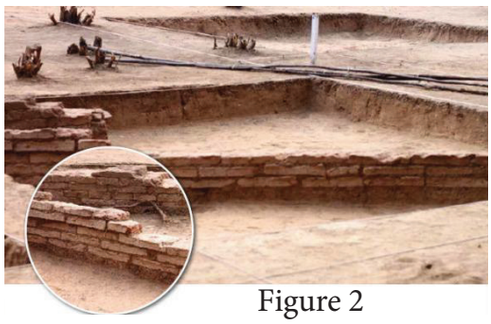


Figure 2

In this technique, the variation of the magnetic field in comparison with the neighbouring place is studied. The magnetic field variation is due to the presence of magnetic mineral magnetite and its related minerals present in the archeological structures like buried wall, pottery, bricks, buried tombs, monuments and inhabited sites. Those minerals are either diamagnetic or paramagnetic or ferromagnetic in nature and each type has different range of magnetic susceptibilities.

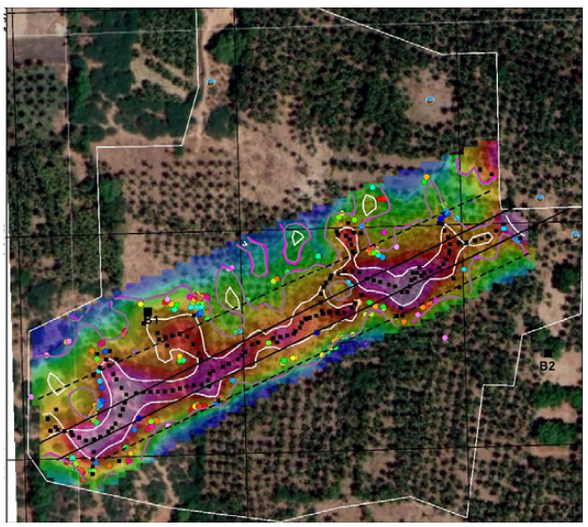


Figure 1

Indian Institute of Geomagnetism (IIG), Mumbai conducted magnetometer survey on Keezhadi site and found out that there were archeological structures like wall, pottery etc. From the picture (Figure 1), there was magnetic field variation in the range of 10 to 100nT over the particular area (coloured portion). In fact, the existence of massive brick structures at Keezhadi has been revealed through magnetism (Figure 2).

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